

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET C — NCERT EXEMPLAR, IN-TEXT SOURCES & TRICKY QUESTIONS****CHAPTER 07: ELECTIONS**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-C-07

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET C - NCERT Exemplar & Tricky Questions):

1. The question paper comprises **25 NCERT Exemplar & Critical Application Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. Tests **in-text source boxes, fine glossary definitions, historical source extracts, and tricky boundary cases**.
3. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
4. Darken the corresponding bubble on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

**NCERT IN-TEXT & EXEMPLAR TIER:** Questions in this set explore subtle details, specialized definitions, and non-intuitive concepts drawn directly from official NCERT text margins, source boxes, and glossary entries.**Q.1 According to the Election Commission of India's criteria, what is required for a political party to be officially recognized as a 'National Party'?**

- (A) Securing at least 6% of valid votes in four or more states in Lok Sabha/Assembly elections plus winning 4 Lok Sabha seats, OR winning at least 2% of Lok Sabha seats (11 seats) from at least 3 states
- (B) Operating a website visited by 10 million people
- (C) Having party offices in all countries of the United Nations
- (D) Donating 100 crore rupees directly to the national treasury

Q.2 What security architecture inside an Indian Electronic Voting Machine (EVM) prevents unauthorized remote wireless hacking or bluetooth tampering?

- (A) EVMs are standalone, air-gapped computers with no internet, Wi-Fi, or Bluetooth hardware; their microcontrollers use masked, one-time programmable (OTP) firmware that cannot be reprogrammed
- (B) EVMs are guarded by trained military eagles at every booth
- (C) EVMs run on public cloud software linked to the internet
- (D) EVMs use modern commercial smartphone operating systems

Q.3 Under Section 8 of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, what is the mandatory consequence for a sitting MP or MLA convicted of a criminal offense with a sentence of 2 years or more?

- (A) Immediate disqualification from legislative membership from the date of conviction, and a ban on contesting elections for the sentence period plus an additional six years
- (B) A verbal reprimand issued by the district collector
- (C) The legislator is given an automatic promotion to cabinet minister
- (D) The conviction carries zero consequence for political office

Q.4 What proportion of randomly selected polling stations in every assembly constituency must have their paper VVPAT slips physically counted to verify EVM electronic counts?

- (A) Mandatory physical counting of VVPAT slips from 5 randomly selected polling stations per assembly constituency
- (B) Zero polling stations; physical counting is prohibited by law
- (C) 100% of all polling stations must be counted manually by hand in every election
- (D) Only one polling station in the entire nation is checked

Q.5 What is the 'None of the Above' (NOTA) provision's legal status in an Indian election if NOTA receives more votes than any single contesting candidate?

- (A) The candidate who receives the highest number of valid votes among the actual candidates is still declared elected under current statutory FPTP rules
- (B) The constituency is permanently dissolved and left empty
- (C) All candidates who contested are sent to prison
- (D) The President of India is declared the winner of the seat

Q.6 What is the primary role of the 'Returning Officer' (RO) in an electoral constituency?

- (A) The statutory district authority (usually District Magistrate/Collector) who oversees candidate nominations, scrutinizes papers, conducts polling, counts votes, and declares the winner
- (B) A police officer who catches people running away from polling booths
- (C) A private campaign manager working for the ruling party
- (D) A foreign diplomat invited to observe the elections

Q.7 Under the Model Code of Conduct, what is the '48-hour silence period' preceding the conclusion of polling in a constituency?

- (A) A statutory ban under Section 126 of RPA on organizing public rallies, campaign speeches, musical concerts, or broadcasting political campaign propaganda on television and radio
- (B) A requirement that all voters stop speaking words for two days
- (C) A ban on all retail shops and grocery markets selling food
- (D) A period where police officers are not allowed to drive cars

Q.8 What is an 'Electoral Bond', which was declared unconstitutional by a unanimous 5-judge Supreme Court bench in February 2024?

- (A) An anonymous bearer banking instrument allowing unlimited corporate donations to political parties without public disclosure, violating the citizens' Right to Information (Article 19(1)(a))
- (B) A gold bond issued to winners of parliamentary elections
- (C) A bond signed by voters promising to vote in every election
- (D) A passport issued to diplomats traveling overseas

Q.9 What is the role of 'Booth Level Officers' (BLOs) appointed by the Election Commission?

- (A) Local government employees (often schoolteachers or anganwadi workers) who conduct door-to-door physical verification to update voter rolls in their neighborhood polling territory
- (B) Armed security guards stationed inside EVM factories
- (C) Political party campaign workers who hand out party flags
- (D) Computer programmers who write software for televisions

Q.10 What is the 'Form 17C' used during Indian elections?

- (A) The statutory account of votes recorded, documenting the serial numbers of EVMs used, total registered electors, and exact number of votes polled at that booth, given to candidate polling agents
- (B) A medical health certificate required before voting
- (C) A receipt for paying election campaign entry taxes
- (D) A license required to operate television cameras at rallies

Q.11 What is the 'mock poll' conducted inside every polling station before actual voting begins at 7:00 AM on election day?

- (A) A mandatory test vote of at least 50 votes cast across all candidates in the presence of candidate polling agents to prove that the EVM and VVPAT record votes accurately before clearing the memory
- (B) A theatrical drama performed by school children outside the booth
- (C) A mock battle fought between local political party leaders
- (D) A demonstration of how to manufacture a voting machine from wood

Q.12 Under the Model Code of Conduct, what restriction is placed on political parties regarding places of worship during election campaigning?

- (A) Temples, mosques, churches, gurdwaras, or other places of worship cannot be used as forums for election propaganda or political campaign speeches
- (B) Candidates are legally prohibited from praying privately in their homes
- (C) All places of worship are locked by the police for six months
- (D) Religious leaders must contest all parliamentary elections by law

Q.13 What is the function of the 'Braille ballot sheet' attached to modern Indian Electronic Voting Machines?

- (A) It features embossed Braille numbering next to candidate buttons to enable visually impaired voters to cast their ballots independently without a companion
- (B) It prints Braille books for the public school library
- (C) It translates the election results into foreign languages
- (D) It gives special financial discounts to voters who can read Braille

Q.14 What is 'tendered ballot' in the Indian electoral process?

- (A) A ballot paper issued to a genuine voter who discovers that someone else has already fraudulently cast a vote in their name
- (B) A vote cast by a child who is only ten years old
- (C) A vote purchased by paying ten thousand rupees
- (D) A vote cast by sending an electronic email to the election officer

Q.15 Why is the 'First-Past-The-Post' system preferred in India over complex 'Proportional Representation' (PR) for general parliamentary elections?

- (A) It is simple and easy for ordinary voters to understand, links a representative clearly to a specific geographical constituency, and tends to produce stable parliamentary majorities
- (B) Because Proportional Representation is completely illegal under international law
- (C) Because Indian voters are prohibited from reading candidate names
- (D) Because PR requires all citizens to hold university doctorate degrees

Q.16 What is a 'postal ballot' and which categories of voters are legally permitted to vote through it in India?

- (A) Voting via post for armed forces service voters deployed away from home, election personnel on duty, and senior citizens over 85 / persons with disabilities who opt for home voting
- (B) Voting by sending a postcard to a television news channel
- (C) A ballot delivered by commercial private airline pilots
- (D) Anyone who prefers not to walk to the local neighborhood polling booth

Q.17 What is the statutory role of the 'Presiding Officer' on polling day?

- (A) The administrative official in charge of a specific polling station responsible for maintaining order, regulating voter queues, operating the EVM, and sealing machines after polling
- (B) The judge who sentences criminals in the district court
- (C) A candidate contesting the election in that constituency
- (D) A journalist reporting live on television from inside the booth

Q.18 What is an 'Election Petition' under Article 329(b) of the Constitution?

- (A) A legal petition filed in the High Court after an election to challenge the validity of the election result on grounds of corrupt practices, illegal nomination, or counting errors
- (B) A petition asking the government for free food during campaigning
- (C) A signature campaign organized by school students before elections
- (D) A request to delay the election for ten years

Q.19 Why does the Election Commission enforce a strict ban on publishing 'Exit Polls' until the conclusion of the final phase of a multi-phase national election?

- (A) To prevent early exit poll predictions from unduly influencing voter behavior, turnout, and psychology in constituencies voting in later phases
- (B) Because television cameras are banned during all elections
- (C) Because exit poll companies are owned by foreign military agencies
- (D) To keep election results secret for fifty years

Q.20 What is the 'Green Paper Seal' applied to an Electronic Voting Machine?

- (A) A serialized, tamper-evident security paper seal that locks the inner door of the Result section of the Control Unit after the mock poll, signed by polling agents
- (B) A sticker that shows the machine was made from recycled leaves
- (C) A receipt given to voters to buy groceries after voting
- (D) A green flag waved to start voting at 7:00 AM

Q.21 How does the 'Voter Guide' slip distributed by the Election Commission assist citizens?

- (A) It provides information on the polling station location, serial number in the voter list, date and hours of polling, and acceptable identity documents
- (B) It tells the citizen which political party they must vote for
- (C) It gives the citizen a free train ticket to travel across India
- (D) It exempts the citizen from paying all future income taxes

Q.22 What constitutes an 'Electoral Offense' of undue influence under Section 171C of the Indian Penal Code?

- (A) Voluntarily interfering or attempting to interfere with the free exercise of any electoral right through threats of injury, social ostracism, or divine displeasure
- (B) Distributing printed pamphlets explaining a party's educational manifesto
- (C) Organizing a peaceful public rally with official municipal permits
- (D) Voting early in the morning before breakfast

Q.23 What is the maximum number of candidates that can be accommodated on a single standard Balloting Unit of an Indian EVM?

- (A) 16 candidates (including NOTA) (B) 5 candidates only
(C) 50 candidates (D) 100 candidates

Q.24 What is the 'Strong Room' where EVMs are stored after polling until counting day?

- (A) A doubly-locked, sealed warehouse guarded 24/7 by central paramilitary forces (CRPF/CISF) with CCTV coverage and continuous monitoring by candidate representatives
(B) An open school playground where machines sit in the sun
(C) A room inside the home of the local political party leader (D) A bank vault located in a foreign country

Q.25 In summary, what is the ultimate hallmark of a mature, flourishing democracy's electoral system?

- (A) Elections are so impartial, transparent, and trustworthy that defeated political leaders peacefully accept their loss and hand over state power to victorious rivals without violence
(B) The ruling party always wins 100% of the vote in every single election
(C) Citizens are legally forbidden from criticizing the election outcome (D) Elections take twenty years to complete and cost zero rupees

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET C)

01	(A) (B) (C) (D)	02	(A) (B) (C) (D)	03	(A) (B) (C) (D)	04	(A) (B) (C) (D)	05	(A) (B) (C) (D)
06	(A) (B) (C) (D)	07	(A) (B) (C) (D)	08	(A) (B) (C) (D)	09	(A) (B) (C) (D)	10	(A) (B) (C) (D)
11	(A) (B) (C) (D)	12	(A) (B) (C) (D)	13	(A) (B) (C) (D)	14	(A) (B) (C) (D)	15	(A) (B) (C) (D)
16	(A) (B) (C) (D)	17	(A) (B) (C) (D)	18	(A) (B) (C) (D)	19	(A) (B) (C) (D)	20	(A) (B) (C) (D)
21	(A) (B) (C) (D)	22	(A) (B) (C) (D)	23	(A) (B) (C) (D)	24	(A) (B) (C) (D)	25	(A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET C)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & In-Depth Conceptual Solution
Q.1	(A)	ECI symbols order criteria: a recognized National Party must demonstrate broad multi-state electoral footprint across at least 4 states in votes and seats.
Q.2	(A)	EVMs are 100% standalone, battery-operated units manufactured by BEL and ECIL; their proprietary OTP chips are burned at the foundry and physically lack wireless transmitters or antennas.
Q.3	(A)	Following the Supreme Court's *Lily Thomas* ruling (2013), convicted lawmakers serving 2+ years face immediate disqualification without any 3-month appeal stay.
Q.4	(A)	Pursuant to the Supreme Court order in 2019, the ECI conducts mandatory manual VVPAT slip verification for 5 randomly selected polling stations in every assembly constituency.
Q.5	(A)	While NOTA provides a symbolic democratic rejection, under current parliamentary election law, plurality rules: the candidate with the most votes after NOTA is declared elected.
Q.6	(A)	The Returning Officer (RO) is the statutory head of the constituency under the RPA, responsible for accepting nominations, polling logistics, vote counting, and issuing the certificate of election.
Q.7	(A)	The 48-hour campaign blackout enables electors to reflect quietly, insulating communities from last-minute high-decibel propaganda, hate speech, and canvassing.
Q.8	(A)	The Supreme Court struck down the Electoral Bond Scheme in 2024, holding that anonymous political financing violates voters' fundamental Right to Information about funding sources.
Q.9	(A)	BLOs are grassroots officials who visit local residences to verify entries, add new 18-year-old voters, and delete deceased names to maintain clean electoral rolls.
Q.10	(A)	Form 17C records the exact vote tally at each polling station; copies signed by the Presiding Officer are given to all polling agents to verify against counting day tallies.
Q.11	(A)	At least 50 mock votes are cast in front of candidate agents, VVPAT slips are matched against the display, the memory is cleared to zero, and the machine is sealed with paper seals.
Q.12	(A)	The MCC strictly prohibits using places of worship for electioneering or using communal/religious appeals to harvest votes, preserving communal harmony.
Q.13	(A)	EVM balloting units feature embossed Braille numerals (1 to 16) alongside candidate buttons, ensuring secret and independent voting for visually impaired citizens.
Q.14	(A)	If an impersonator has already voted in a voter's name, the presiding officer verifies the true voter's identity and gives them a 'Tendered Ballot Paper' sealed in a special envelope.
Q.15	(A)	FPTP is simple, provides clear local constituency accountability (citizens know their local MP), and avoids the extreme coalition instability of multi-member party-list PR.
Q.16	(A)	Service voters (armed forces), polling staff on duty, and recently senior citizens (85+) and persons with benchmark disabilities can cast postal ballots under strict ECI supervision.
Q.17	(A)	The Presiding Officer manages the booth, verifies voter entry, maintains the ballot register (Form 17A), supervises polling agents, and seals EVMs with green paper seals.
Q.18	(A)	Election results can be challenged only via an Election Petition presented to the High Court of the state within 45 days of the declaration of results.
Q.19	(A)	Section 126A of the RPA bans exit poll telecasts from the start of the first phase until half an hour after voting closes in the final phase to prevent bandwagon effects.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & In-Depth Conceptual Solution
Q.20	(A)	The Control Unit's Result door is sealed with a serialized green paper seal; agents sign across it, and tampering breaks the paper, ensuring results cannot be accessed before counting day.
Q.21	(A)	Voter Information Slips distributed by BLOs contain the elector's photograph, polling booth number, and serial number, facilitating smooth check-in at the booth.
Q.22	(A)	Undue influence includes threatening voters with physical harm, excommunication, caste boycott, or spiritual damnation to coerce their vote choice.
Q.23	(A)	A single Balloting Unit accommodates 16 candidate buttons (including NOTA); up to 24 Balloting Units can be daisy-chained to a single Control Unit to handle up to 384 candidates.
Q.24	(A)	Post-polling EVMs are sealed in Strong Rooms with double locks (one key with the RO, one with an assistant), guarded by central armed police with live CCTV monitors in candidate camps.
Q.25	(A)	The ultimate test of democratic elections is peaceful turnover of power: losing incumbents honorably concede, respecting the sovereign will of the people.